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r/GooglePixel • 3mo ago

Dacros

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Hey Google, are you okay..?

I don't normally tend to write long posts like this. However, I have gone through such a (to me) bizarre experience in the last few weeks that I felt like speaking out.

For around 18 months, I have owned and used a Pixel 8. It was my first Pixel phone, and coming from OnePlus it was the promise of a long period of software support that won me over. I use loads of Google stuff in my household as well. Sure, I've had my struggles with the assistant, and I have been hurt by the Google Graveyard (looking at you, Stadia), but overall, the Pixel would fit like a glove. And so it did, for the past 18 months.

However, at one point, my phone started rebooting arbitrarily at one point. This came out of nowhere, and at first I thought it was a software issue. After troubleshooting however, I could not fix the issue. Turns out that having a phone that randomly reboots is a pretty annoying issue, as this means that calls and texts stop coming through. I needed a solution, and since I couldn't seem to fix this through software, I started looking at the possibility that the issue was related to hardware.

A couple of days later, I randomly stumbled on what was the issue: when using the on/off button to turn off the phone's screen, the phone somehow opened the power menu. "That's weird", I thought to myself, as that should only happen with a long press (2 seconds). Some 20 seconds later, the Google logo appeared on the screen, and voila, the phone rebooted. Turns out that this was the problem. The phone registered the initial press, but somehow didn't register me letting go of the button. Thinking I just kept pressing the button, the phone at one point figured I must want a hard reboot, so there we go.

As a European, my phone was still under warranty. So, I contacted Google support. This is where the real circus begins in all its bizarre glory. I was first told to go through the troubleshooting again. Resetting a phone to factory settings is not a fun experience to go through. Setting everything up again simply takes time, which is annoying. But sure, after going through all of it again, and confirming that my issue still was not fixed, we moved on to the next step.

The next step was to request a repair through Google's online support page. I was told by the agent to select two options: problem with button, and problem with power supply (excuse me if this is not the exact wording, as I went through the page in my mother tongue). Already at this point it stood out to me that there was no way to actually provide more information about the specific issue, but hey, the Support agent knew what was going on, so surely things would be okay, right?

Seeing as Google doesn't have a Service Center in my country, I had to send in my phone. This was pretty annoying, as I'd need to use my old phone for some time. My old phone only supports two physical SIM cards, and as the Pixel only supports the one physical SIM and then an e-SIM, I needed to swap my e-SIM for a physical one. This actually cost me a little bit of money, but who cares, right? I just want my phone fixed under warranty.

Anyways, I received a UPS priority shipping label for that purpose, so it cost me nothing. The phone was shipped to Poland for repairs. Around two days after shipping, I received an e-mail stating that my phone had been received and examined. The problem had been found: there was a defect in my screen! This surprised me, as my screen had looked perfectly fine from the outside. But hey, what do I know. Perhaps it was one of those situations where they had to fix one thing to fix the other thing. Anyway, the phone was repaired, shipped back to me from Poland (again with super fast shipping), and within 10 days the problem was fixed, right..?

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evidence of what happened. With this, I wanted to show Google support my theory about the on/off button being the culprit. The support agent did their best, and in the end they offered to provide another repair job. They would initiate this repair job themselves, so that nothing could go wrong this time. I'd have to send the phone to Poland again, but hey, at least it would be fixed now.

A couple of days after sending on the phone for the second time, Google emailed me again, saying they found the problem this time: the battery of my Pixel phone was defect! This seemed weird to me, as, like with my screen, I has experienced no issues whatsoever. Furthermore, Google themselves never found any issue with my battery the first time they had serviced the phone just days before this second attempt. So I decided to pick up the phone again, and I pleaded with the support agent to intervene in the process. See, I need my phone for my work life and my family life, and I couldn't stand the thought of having to send it in for a third time. The support agent contacted some expert team, and the answer he could provide me with was that the repair center decides what is defect and what isn't, and that Support was not able to intervene with this process. Chinese walls and all that. I just needed to wait patiently and it would all be resolved. At this point I felt kind of annoyed, but what can you do?

A couple of days later, the phone came back from Poland again. New screen and new battery, but within 10 minutes I had again found the issue to still be there. So I again recorded video proof of the issue, and contacted Google support. After going through a 10 minute script and feeling more and more let down, I asked for my money back. See, Google, in their Warranty Policy for the EU, states repair, replacement, or reimbursement as options under warranty. No dice, the agent told me. They could, however, contact the expert team again to see what they could do for me.

After a short wait, the agent came on the line again and stayed they could offer me three solutions to the problem. The first one, I kid you not, was that I were to contact the third party (my telecom provider) of which i bought the phone to see if they would fix the problem for me. I asserted that I knew my rights, and that this was in no way a viable option. Quite frankly, I was offended by them even saying this after how badly this repair process went so far.

The second and third options, however, were variations on a replacement device. I could either send in my own device, and receive a new (possibly refurbished) one of the same spec, or do the same thing the other way around. I chose the second variation. New phone, problem finally solved (I think, as it is charging now).

What bothers me is how insanely unoptimized this whole process has been from beginning to end. From not being able to provide any details on what actually needed fixing, to the support agents not being able to contact the repair service, to them on the end not even being able to repair a simple bloody knob, but instead opting to repair stuff that wasn't broken in the first place. Let alone the sustainability nightmare that has them shipping my phone over a thousand kilometres one way four (!) times to in the end just decide that they are unable to fix the problem. I work in process management, and if I were to suggest a process like this to my boss, I guarantee you I would be fired on the spot. It seems absolutely insane to me that this is the way Google handles its warranty process. We'd call this an absolute dissatisfier in my field.

All the while nobody seemed to be able to help out in any meaningful way. Nobody ever apologized for the inconvenience of having to go without my phone for over 20 days, and in the end, they sent me a refurbished phone without so much as a thank you for sticking to them through this ordeal.

This whole process has made sure that I will think twice about buying any Google product from now on. Software support is very nice, but only if hardware isn't the limiting factor.

I guess I shouldn't be surprised. But I am extremely disappointed. Apologies for the long post.

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Sort by: **Best** ▾[Search Comments](#)**felicityfelix** • 3mo ago

Something I have learned from reading this sub is that nothing good happens after the phone goes to Poland lol

**XiuOtr** • 3mo ago

Bro, that IS a way serious crazy long post.

I'm impressed with everyone that actually read it.

What was then end result?

**Dacros** **OP** • 3mo ago

TLDR is at the end :-)

**XiuOtr** • 3mo ago**Loranda** • 3mo ago

This has been my exact ordeal with my P6 when it started to drain battery after a year. Back and forth with useless support and days without phone with a refurbished replacement in the end and endless hassle.

This along with the horror stories of people having their Google accounts terminated for support issues.

 Create**androgynyjoe** • 3mo ago

The law says that they have to repair it, but the law does not say that they have to make it convenient. I guess this is a little bit cynical of me, but I imagine that they are aware that the process is frustrating and...might discourage people from using it.

**Zog1** • 3mo ago

You probably have malware on the phone.

You can't reset an android phone just by the post button itself

**Zog1** • 3mo ago

Power button